

JShotz Quick Guide

Version 3.14.1

JShotz records your browsing as a series of screenshots and turns them into a PDF or Word document - handy for documenting a process, a support case, or a step-by-step walkthrough.

Getting started

- Load JShotz as a browser extension, then click the JShotz icon in your toolbar. Do not open popup.html directly from its folder; it needs the browser extension runtime to record.
- Choose a Capture source:
 - Tab viewport only - screenshots of the page you're on.
 - API + Screenshot - same, plus a table of the page's network calls under each shot. JShotz observes page network calls only while this source is selected.
 - Screen / window - share your whole screen, a window, or a tab (the only option that can show DevTools or other apps).
- Click Start recording.
- Use the page normally - screenshots are taken automatically as you click and scroll. JShotz keeps the resulting documents in the order you acted, even when a screen waits to render; each frame's title and URL come from the page being captured.
- To take a break without ending the session, click Pause recording. It becomes Continue recording; continuing keeps the same screenshots, numbering, and session folder.
- Need a checkpoint without stopping? Click Save checkpoint (Shift+Ctrl+S). Enter a file name, choose PDF, Word, or both, and JShotz keeps the current recording active. A toast confirms whether the save succeeded or failed.
- Need a final save without opening the file location? Press Ctrl+S or click Stop recording, then choose Yes, keep and Save and stop (Ctrl+S). It saves the selected documents, ends the recording, and shows a saved-file toast.
- Choose Save, stop, and open file location (Ctrl+Alt+S) to save the selected documents, end the recording, and reveal the browser-download location.
- When you are done with the final flow, clear unwanted frames in the Screenshots list, then click Stop recording. The confirmation appears directly under that button: choose Yes, keep to choose a custom name and PDF, Word, or both, then select Save and stop (Ctrl+S) or Save, stop, and open file location (Ctrl+Alt+S). Choose Stop without document to keep the captured files and manifest without a document, or No, delete all to discard the session and its interim backup.
- After keeping a stopped session, use Generate evidences to create another PDF, Word document, or both from the checked screenshots. Enter a name, choose the formats, and JShotz writes them to the same selected folder or Downloads session folder. If an output document already has that name, JShotz appends its creation timestamp instead of replacing it.

You can change the capture source at any time without stopping the recording.

JShotz updates one JShotz-interim.pdf after screenshot 5 and every five screenshots after that.

It overwrites that same file in the selected capture folder or in the session's Downloads folder, so it does not create a new backup file for every checkpoint. A successful final PDF or Word save removes the interim PDF. Stop without document, a browser crash, or an accidental browser close keeps the latest interim PDF available.

If the browser restarts during an active recording, JShotz ends that recording safely instead of binding it to whichever tab is currently open. The popup reports the interruption, retains the stored screenshots, and offers Generate evidences. Start a new recording for a new flow, or use Resume capture from folder to continue a folder-backed flow.

To continue a folder-backed flow after a browser or extension crash, use Resume capture from folder, choose that folder, then click Start recording. JShotz loads that folder's screenshots, starts at the next number, and includes the old and new screenshots in its checkpoint and final documents. If the selected folder has no previous PNG or JPEG screenshots, Start recording creates a new recording there and writes the current flow to it.

If Chrome no longer grants write access to that selected folder, recording still continues and new screenshots go to the normal Downloads session folder. Use Reconnect capture folder when you want later screenshots and final documents to write directly to the original folder again. Reconnecting an empty selected folder is supported and confirms that the current flow will be captured there.

If Chrome says JShotz needs access after a redirect, open the JShotz popup on the current page and continue recording. For flows that move between websites, set JShotz Site access to On all sites in Chrome's extension details.

Updating the extension

Unzip the new JShotz package, load the folder containing manifest.json from chrome://extensions or edge://extensions, and make sure only one JShotz copy is enabled. Then close and reopen any browser tab that was already open during the update before recording.

Chrome may retain an Extension context invalidated error for an old page script; delete that error card after reopening the tab.

Capturing a screenshot manually

To do this	Do this
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Capture right now	Click Capture now in the popup
Capture with the keyboard	Press Ctrl+Alt+Q
Capture a DevTools panel	Open the panel, press Alt+Shift+S

| Capture in 5 seconds (time to click into DevTools) | Click Capture in 5s, or press Alt+Shift+D |

Getting the whole page in one shot

Turn on "Whole-page shots for manual captures and responsive layouts" in settings. It captures the entire page - including everything below the fold - when you use Capture now, Ctrl+Alt+Q, or Capture in 5s. It also uses long screenshots automatically for a narrow responsive layout, including Chrome DevTools Device Mode. Desktop automatic captures (clicks and scrolling) remain normal single-screen shots.

Very long pages are saved as adjacent, numbered parts instead of one oversized image. Narrow responsive pages are divided into readable sections so their PDF evidence does not shrink to a thin strip. The parts remain in order when you export a document. A progress bar appears in the popup and on the page while the whole-page capture is running, then disappears when it finishes.

Responsive layouts, including Chrome DevTools Device Mode, stitch overlapping visible frames directly. This preserves the responsive viewport and restores the original scroll position when it finishes. If you stop recording while a long capture is active, JShotz cancels it promptly and discards its unfinished frame. Do not interact with the page until the progress bar disappears.

For ordinary documents, Chrome may show a "started debugging this browser" banner for a moment.

Saving documents while you continue

Click Save checkpoint (Shift+Ctrl+S) at any point to open a compact save dialog. Enter the custom base name, select PDF, Word, or both, and save a checkpoint without stopping the recording. The current screenshots, numbering, and output selection remain available for later work. A toast reports the save result.

The checkpoint document is written alongside the active session's other output. The Preselect PDF in output dialogs option controls the initial format choice; each dialog always lets you choose PDF, Word, or both.

Modal windows

JShotz captures a modal once when it opens. While a fixed modal is visible, scrolling the page

behind it does not create screenshots. A large modal with a real scrollable body is captured when you scroll substantially inside it; small modal scroll areas are ignored. Modal buttons, edits, and selected values create one settled screenshot each. Non-scrollable modals are exported as a compact modal-only image instead of a full-page duplicate. Cookie-consent banners and other wide in-page consent overlays stay in the full viewport capture with the page behind them.

Choose output screenshots and add notes

Every captured screenshot starts selected for document output. Before a checkpoint, final export, or post-stop evidence generation:

- Clear the checkbox beside any screenshot you do not want in the document.
- Use Select all to include every screenshot again.
- Use Show older screenshots when the recording has more than 50 captures.
- Enter an optional note of up to 50 characters under a screenshot. A saved note appears after that screenshot's heading in brackets in PDF and Word output.

Your selection remains with the active or most recently kept recording when the popup closes. Only selected screenshots appear in checkpoint, final, and evidence documents. Evidence generation remains available until you start a new recording.

Resume an interrupted capture

- Open the page where you want to continue the flow.
- Click Resume capture from folder in the popup.
- Choose the earlier session's screenshot folder in the native folder dialog and allow read/write access.
- Click Start recording. JShotz refreshes the Screenshots list with the earlier files and captures the current page as the next screenshot.

When the selected folder has no previous PNG or JPEG screenshots, JShotz treats it as the current flow's output folder instead. Start recording begins a new recording there and confirms that captures are being written to the selected folder. Without selecting a resume folder, Start recording always creates a fresh session and Downloads folder after a stop or browser restart.

New PNG files, checkpoint and final PDF/Word documents, and the refreshed flow-manifest.json are written to that same selected folder. No browser tab is opened for this action. It is available in Chrome and Edge; Firefox can record normally but cannot write directly into an arbitrary existing folder.

If Chrome or Edge asks for folder access again while an active folder-backed recording remains open, the button becomes Reconnect capture folder. After a browser restart, choose Resume capture from folder instead.

Shortcuts and common fixes

- Ctrl+Alt+Q: capture manually while the page has focus.
- Alt+Shift+S: capture the currently visible DevTools panel.
- Alt+Shift+D: start a five-second countdown, then capture. Use this when you need time to click into DevTools.
- Shift+Ctrl+S: open the checkpoint save dialog and keep recording after it is saved.
- Ctrl+S: open the final save dialog, save the chosen output, and stop recording without opening the file location.
- Ctrl+Alt+S: open the final save dialog, save the chosen output, stop recording, and open its browser-download location.

You can change extension shortcuts at <chrome://extensions/shortcuts> or the Firefox equivalent.

If a page was open while JShotz was installed, reloaded, or updated, refresh that page before recording. Browser internal pages and the extension store cannot be recorded because browsers protect them from extensions.

Every screenshot in the Screenshots list starts checked. Clear the checkbox beside any frame you do not want in output. Select all is checked while every frame is included and clears when any individual frame is removed. The choice remains for the current recording if the popup closes and is reopened.

After resuming a folder, the same selection list contains the earlier and newly captured screenshots.

Only checked screenshots are included in checkpoint and final documents. Notes entered under a screenshot are retained in the active recording and written as [note] after its heading.

Where do my files go?

Everything is saved under your Downloads folder:

`Downloads/flow-captures/session<date-time>/`

This includes your screenshots, selected PDF and/or Word documents, evidence documents, and a technical debugLog inside flow-manifest.json for troubleshooting. The log is stored in the extension background while you record, so it never interrupts a recording with a separate download prompt.

The custom base name you enter is used for .pdf and/or .docx files. Checkpoint defaults include

checkpoint<date-time> so repeated saves do not replace earlier checkpoints.

Evidence output uses the same folder as the stopped recording. If a selected evidence filename already exists, JShotz creates a new version by appending <date-time> before its extension.

When you resume from a folder, JShotz writes new files directly beside the earlier screenshots in the folder you selected instead of creating a new Downloads session folder.

Multiple tabs

If the page you're recording opens a new tab (like a sign-in redirect), JShotz follows it automatically. Switching back and forth between tabs keeps capturing wherever you are.

Pausing

does not remove those tracked tabs or child windows, so continuing follows the same browser flow.

Need help?

If something doesn't look right, note roughly when it happened and what you were doing, and share that along with the screenshot in question.